



A LETTER TO GOD

English - Class 10 | Complete Comprehensive Study Notes

Author: G.L. Fuentes (Gregorio López y Fuentes)

About the Author:

Gregorio López y Fuentes (1897–1966) was a renowned Mexican novelist, journalist, poet, and short story writer. He actively participated in the Mexican Revolution during his youth, which deeply shaped his writing. Born in a rural area of Veracruz, Mexico, he was closely connected to farmers, indigenous communities, and village life. He worked as a school teacher and newspaper editor. His works belong to social realism and focus on the struggles, faith, and resilience of ordinary rural people. He won Mexico's National Prize for Literature in 1935.

1. Themes and Values

Theme:

- Unshakable faith in God
- Power of hope and optimism in crisis
- Human kindness and compassion
- Irony of blind faith
- Conflict between man and nature
- Gratitude and realism

Values:

- Faith should be balanced with gratitude and practical understanding.
- Kindness and empathy towards others in need.
- Recognition and appreciation of human goodness.
- Selflessness and generosity without expecting anything in return.
- Honesty and sincerity in expressing one's problems.
- Importance of helping others while respecting their beliefs.
- Avoiding suspicion and developing trust in humanity.

2. Characters

Lencho: Protagonist — a poor, hardworking, optimistic farmer with absolute faith in God. He is simple, honest, and literate but becomes naive and ungrateful due to his blind belief.

Postmaster: Kind, empathetic, and generous official who helps Lencho while preserving his faith. Represents human compassion.

Post office employees: Supportive and generous contributors.

Lencho's family: Wife and sons — they show worry and stand by him but have minor roles.

3. In-Depth Summary (Detailed and Long)

The story is set in a beautiful but remote valley surrounded by hills. Lencho, a dedicated farmer, anxiously waits for rain to nourish his ripe corn crop. When the rain finally begins, the entire family rejoices. Lencho joyfully compares the large raindrops to "new silver coins" because he knows they will bring a rich harvest and financial security for the year. His little son runs around playing in the rain, adding to the happy atmosphere. Everyone is filled with hope and excitement.

Unfortunately, the gentle rain soon changes into a terrible hailstorm. For almost an hour, heavy hailstones fall mercilessly, destroying the entire corn field. Not a single leaf or plant is left intact. The fields look as white as if covered with salt. Lencho stands shocked and heartbroken as he surveys the total destruction. He realises that there will be no harvest that year and his family will face starvation and extreme hardship.

Even in this desperate situation, Lencho does not lose hope. He has complete and childlike faith in God. He strongly believes that God, who sees everything and helps those in need, will surely assist him. Being literate, Lencho sits down and writes a letter addressed simply "To God." In the letter, he clearly describes the loss caused by the hailstorm and requests one hundred pesos so that he can buy seeds for the next crop and feed his family until the next harvest. He goes to town the next day and posts the letter.

When the letter reaches the post office, the postman is surprised and shows it to the postmaster. At first, both men laugh at the unusual address. However, after reading the contents, the postmaster is deeply moved by Lencho's sincere faith and innocence. He does not want to shake or disappoint such pure belief. The kind-hearted postmaster decides to help. He contributes money from his own salary and requests his employees and friends to donate as well. Despite their collective effort, they can collect only seventy pesos.

The postmaster puts the seventy pesos into an envelope and sends it to Lencho with "God" written as the sender, so that the farmer's faith remains unbroken. A few days later, Lencho returns to the post office expecting a reply from God. When he opens the letter and counts only seventy pesos, he becomes extremely angry. Instead of feeling thankful for the help he received, he is upset that God sent him less than requested. He immediately writes a second letter to God. In this letter, he thanks God for the money sent but politely asks for the remaining thirty pesos. Most importantly, he warns God not to send the money through the post office because, in his opinion, the employees there are "a bunch of crooks" who stole thirty pesos.

The story ends on this powerful ironic note, showing the contrast between Lencho's pure faith in God and his failure to recognise the kindness shown by fellow human beings.

4. Moral (in points)

- Strong faith in God gives hope and courage during difficult times.
- God often helps through kind-hearted human beings.
- Blind faith can make a person ungrateful and suspicious.
- We must learn to recognise and appreciate the goodness and help from others.
- Small acts of kindness and generosity can bring big changes in someone's life.
- Balance faith with gratitude, realism, and trust in humanity.
- Never judge or accuse others without understanding their intentions.

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